



that the party has put Hindutva on the backburner to look moderate and please the coalition partners. The RSS has conveyed to the party that the 'sadhu-sant' community is not happy with the party but the BJP is now desperate.

**O**n the eve of elections, it wants to project an image of a party that is inclusive and whose main mantra is development. Advani is going out of his way to woo the youth through the Internet and direct meetings. Party sources disclosed that he recently turned down an invitation to a conclave of 'Brahmin Samaj', saying that he didn't want to associate himself with such a casteist function.

Advani has his own reasons to change track at the last minute. With some introspection, the party has realised that it cannot win elections on the Hindutva card, especially since it is working hard to cobble together its coalition and expand the base of the NDA. So far, only

## THE BJP WANTS TO WOO THE **YOUNG** BUT THE **OLD** IN THE PARTY CAN STILL PLAY **SPOILSPORT.**

Om Prakash Chautala's Indian National Lok Dal and the Asom Gana Parishad have firmed up their alliance with the party.

The BJP's terror card also backfired badly during the recently concluded Assembly elections. Contrary to its expectations, 26/11 couldn't win Delhi for the BJP. The party's spin doctors were all set to make the UPA Government's weakness in handling terrorism the main plank for Lok Sabha elections. However, there is a serious rethinking going on within the party on the saleability of

**SHEKHAWAT REFUSES TO RETIRE  
FROM ACTIVE POLITICS**

terrorism in the next elections.

Internally, the differences between Advani and Rajnath Singh also persist. They had resurfaced at the meeting with the RSS leaders at Advani's residence on January 2, where it was discussed who would have the final say in deciding tickets for the upcoming polls. The final upshot was that Singh would decide, but in consultation with Advani.

A new twist has been added to the leadership question in the BJP with top industrialists, including Anil Ambani and Sunil Mittal, endorsing the name of Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi as the country's next leader. Speaking at the Global Investors' Summit in Ahmedabad, the big daddies of Indian industry said that if Modi could do so much for investment in Gujarat, he was also capable of doing the same for India. More bad news for the lion of Rajasthan. And for the BJP, the old refuses to fade out and the young has failed to deliver. ■